

Christina Pizzonia

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Results-driven EE student with a focus in digital signal processing and RTL design. Interested in leveraging past experiences in design for efficient and effective ASIC development.

EDUCATION

BASc, Electrical Engineering + PEY Co-Op, University of Toronto 2022 - 2027

- Relevant coursework: Computer architecture, digital systems, digital signal processing
- Dean's Honour List (cGPA: 3.98/4.00), Editor-in-Chief of [The Cannon](#)

SKILLS

Languages	HDL (Verilog, SystemVerilog), Perl, Tcl, Python, C, C++, MATLAB
Tools	Xcelium, Jasper (Cadence); Quartus, Modelsim (Intel); Vivado (AMD); Git, SVN
Soft Skills	Written and oral communication, project management, technical research

EXPERIENCE

Digital Design Engineer May 2025 - August 2026
Cadence Design Systems *Toronto, ON*

- Worked on high-speed SER-DES PHY

Deep Learning Research Intern May 2024 - Sept 2024
Genov Lab *Toronto, ON*

- Received an NSERC-USRA grant to develop a hardware-efficient, spiking neural network in Python for epileptic seizure prediction, to be implemented on an FPGA
- Performed a literature review on current deep learning algorithms for seizure prediction, and proposed a quantitative method to assess the implementability of algorithms in hardware
- Created a test-bench suite in Verilog to verify the functionality of designs before tape-out; worked with oscilloscopes to test previously manufactured ASICs

Summer Research Student May 2022 - Aug 2022
Passeport Lab *Toronto, ON*

- Processed stormwater samples via density separation and organic digestion (in accordance with lab SOPs) and identified microplastics via FTIR spectroscopy to provide data for publication
- Analyzed microplastic data in Microsoft Excel to determine sources of error & improve accuracy of counting methods by $\approx 50\%$
- Performed a literature review on contaminant [extraction](#) and presented results to 2 academic labs

Tutor Mar 2021 - Present
[Self-Employed](#) *Toronto, ON*

- Have taught over 50 high-school and university students in calculus and improved scores by $> 25\%$
- Have grown a regular client-base from 0 to 10 students through targeted advertising and positive referrals

PROJECTS

Discrete FT Visualizer [[GitHub](#)]: Programmed a Nios II processor on a DE1-SoC FPGA in C to compute and display the discrete Fourier Transform from either input audio or pre-selected waveforms on a monitor.

HerWay [[GitHub](#)]: Created an interactive map and GUI focused on women's safety in C++. Multi-target Dijkstra's, a greedy algorithm and 2-opt with multi-threading was implemented for finding optimal routes.

Bindicator! [[GitHub](#)]: Used waste collection data from [OpenData](#) to program a microcontroller to automatically update an LCD & LEDs with the waste type(s) being collected based on current time and location.

Autonomous Robot [[GitHub](#)]: Designed and programmed an autonomous, line-following robot using Fusion360/AutoCAD and microcontrollers to navigate a track using a bang-bang control algorithm